Perhaps the most critical element to building proper retrieval is the process of document splitting. You can use numerous methods to split a document, including multiple concurrent methods. More than one method passes and splits the document for numerous embedding views of the same document. In the next section, we'll examine a more general technique for splitting documents, using tokens and tokenization.

8.4.2 Splitting documents by token with LangChain

Tokenization is the process of breaking text into word tokens. Where a word token represents a succinct element in the text, a token could be a word like *hold* or even a symbol like the left curly brace ({), depending on what's relevant.

Splitting documents using tokenization provides a better base for how the text will be interpreted by language models and for semantic similarity. Tokenization also allows the removal of irrelevant characters, such as whitespace, making the similarity matching of documents more relevant and generally providing better results.

For the next code exercise, open the `langchain_token_splitting.py` file in VS Code, as shown in listing 8.7. Now we split the document using tokenization, which breaks the document into sections of unequal size. The unequal size results from the large sections of whitespace of the original document.